

How Much to Check

AI can help with almost any task. The real skill is knowing how much to check what it gives you. Some answers need a hard look. Others barely need one.

That’s what trust really comes down to here. Not believing the output automatically, but knowing what kind of follow-up it needs before you use it.

SOMETIMES THE ANSWER IS NO

Before the dial even matters, there’s a faster call. Some moments shouldn’t go to AI at all: the sharpest move is to leave the tool closed and handle it yourself, or hand it to a real person.

DON’T REACH FOR IT WHEN

THE RULE ALREADY SAYS NO

- The assignment or policy forbids it.
- You’d be using it to dodge the very skill you’re there to build.

IT INVOLVES PRIVATE INFORMATION

- You’d have to paste your own sensitive details.
- It means handing over someone else’s private information.

YOU CAN'T STAND BEHIND THE RESULT

- You can’t verify whether the output is true.
- It’s a high-stakes call that needs a qualified human.
- It would act under your name without your review.

IT'S YOURS, OR IT NEEDS A PERSON

- The task needs your own voice or judgment.
- Someone is in real danger and needs a person, now.

FOR EVERYTHING ELSE, SET THE DIAL

Everything else is fair game. From here, the question becomes how much follow-up the answer needs. Start by naming the **type of task** you are asking AI to do. Some task types are easy to judge on your own and need little follow-up. Other task types almost always need follow-up because the answer has to be true, current, safe, sourced, or genuinely yours.

